



AGAPAY
LOVE HOW YOU GIVE

PARISH ONBOARDING & OPERATIONS GUIDE

Stripe, Payouts & the Parish+ Bookstore

A complete, practical guide for activating AGAPAY Giving, connecting Stripe, managing deposits, reconciling transactions, and adding parish bookstore sales.

VERIFY	Parish EIN, legal information, and authorized representative
CONNECT	Stripe Express and the parish bank account
LAUNCH	Giving funds, campaigns, calendar, link, and QR code
RECONCILE	Balances, payouts, transaction fees, and reports
SELL	Parish+ Bookstore commerce with no AGAPAY transaction fee

OVERVIEW

Your AGAPAY Setup at a Glance

Most parishes can complete the initial setup in about 15-20 minutes once the required information is ready. Verification review may take longer if Stripe requests additional documentation.

What You'll Need

Item	What to Have Ready
Parish EIN / Tax ID	The parish or monastery federal Employer Identification Number.
Parish bank details	ACH routing number and checking-account number.
Organization information	Legal name, physical address, phone, email, and website or AGAPAY page.
Authorized representative	Name, home address, date of birth, phone, email, and government-issued ID.
AGAPAY invitation	The onboarding email or dashboard access supplied after parish verification.

The Five-Part Flow

1

Open the invitation
Use the AGAPAY onboarding link and parish credentials.

2

Activate the Giving plan
Choose the appropriate parish tier and complete subscription checkout.

3

Connect Stripe
Complete Stripe-hosted organization, representative, and bank verification.

4

Configure Giving
Add funds and campaigns, select the liturgical calendar, and activate the page.

5

Review and reconcile
Confirm a test gift, understand payout timing, and establish a monthly reconciliation routine.

IMPORTANT

Use a dedicated parish administrator account. Treat AGAPAY and Stripe access as financial access, and enable strong authentication wherever available.

PART 1

Invitation, Login & Subscription

Open the AGAPAY Invitation

After parish verification, AGAPAY provides access to the parish dashboard. The invitation should identify the parish account and direct the administrator to the setup workflow.

- 1 Open the dashboard link
Use the link in the AGAPAY onboarding email.
- 2 Sign in with the supplied credentials
Enter the parish identifier and temporary password, if one was provided.
- 3 Change the temporary password
Use a strong password known only to authorized parish personnel.
- 4 Begin the setup workflow
Complete billing before connecting Stripe when the dashboard presents the steps in that order.

AGAPAY Giving Plans

Plan	Monthly Platform Fee	Total Donation Fee	Best Fit
Mission	\$49/month	5% + \$0.30	Missions and smaller communities
Parish	\$99/month	5% + \$0.30	Established parishes
Cathedral / Multi-parish	Custom	5% + \$0.30	Cathedrals, dioceses, and larger accounts
Monastic	\$0/month	5% + \$0.30	Monasteries, sketes, and convents
NOTE The 5% + \$0.30 amount is the single total transaction fee for standard online donations. It is not added on top of Stripe's processing fee.			

PART 2

Connect the Parish Stripe Account

Stripe hosts the sensitive onboarding and verification process. AGAPAY does not require the parish to create an unrelated standard Stripe account first.

Complete the Stripe Onboarding Sections

1

Organization or business type

Select the option that accurately reflects the parish's actual legal organization. Do not guess.

2

Legal organization information

Enter the legal name, address, phone, email, and website exactly as supported by parish records.

3

Tax identification

Enter the parish EIN. Do not substitute a personal Social Security number for the parish EIN.

4

Authorized representative

Provide the requested personal information for an authorized priest, treasurer, council officer, or other representative.

5

Bank account

Enter a parish-owned checking account for payouts.

6

Identity documentation

Upload a clear, current government-issued ID if Stripe requests it.

7

Review and submit

Check every entry carefully and submit the account for verification.

IMPORTANT

Stripe may verify the account quickly or request additional documents. Payouts can remain paused until all required information is accepted.

TIP

If an onboarding link is expired or unavailable, return to AGAPAY and generate or request a fresh Stripe connection link.

PART 3

Verification & Bank Account Controls

Verification Checklist

- Legal name matches parish and IRS records.
- EIN is entered correctly.
- Representative information is complete and accurate.
- Uploaded documents are clear, current, and uncropped.
- The payout account belongs to the parish or monastery.
- Every Stripe alert has been reviewed and resolved.

Adding the Payout Account

1

Open Stripe Express
Launch the connected account from the AGAPAY dashboard.

2

Find payout or bank settings
Stripe labels may include Bank Accounts, External Accounts, Payout Details, or Settings.

3

Enter verified bank information
Use the ACH routing number and parish account number from official bank records.

4

Complete bank verification
Stripe may verify instantly or use another verification method.

5

Confirm the first successful payout
Do not close an old bank account until a payout has successfully reached the new account.

IMPORTANT

Closing the old bank account before updating Stripe can cause failed payouts and delayed access to funds.

Where to Find the Numbers

Source	Routing Number	Account Number
Paper check	Usually the left-most 9-digit number	Usually the center number; length varies
Online banking	Account details or routing information	Account details or full account information
Bank support	Ask for the ACH routing number	Ask for the checking or DDA account number

PART 4

Configure & Launch the Giving Page

Once Stripe is connected and the account is able to receive payments, complete the parish-facing giving setup before distributing the link or QR code.

Pre-Launch Configuration

Configuration	Recommended Action
Designated Funds	Add General Operating and any other active restricted or designated funds.
Giving Campaigns	Create active parish needs, appeals, or time-limited campaigns.
Feast-aware Giving	Enable the relevant feast offerings and confirm the parish calendar.
Liturgical Calendar	Select Julian or Revised Julian according to parish practice.
Giving Page Status	Set the page to Active only after the content and Stripe status are ready.
QR Code and Link	Download the QR code and test both the code and direct giving-page URL.

Run a Test

1

Open the public giving page
Use a private browser window or another device.

2

Make a small test gift
Confirm that the form completes successfully.

3

Verify the transaction
Confirm that the payment appears in AGAPAY and Stripe.

4

Confirm the fund designation
Make sure the gift is attributed to the intended fund or campaign.

5

Confirm payout readiness
Check that the Stripe account shows no unresolved restrictions.

TIP

Do not share the QR code broadly until the public page, receipt flow, fund designation, and dashboard record have all been tested.

PART 5

Balances, Payouts & Reconciliation

Understanding the Balance

Status	Meaning	Next Step
Pending	Payment has been received but is not yet available for payout.	Wait for Stripe clearance and any review period.
Available	Funds have cleared and are ready for payout.	Included in the next scheduled payout.
In Transit	Stripe has initiated the bank deposit.	Wait for the bank to post the deposit.
Paid	The payout has reached the parish bank account.	Reconcile the bank deposit to the included transactions.

Payout Schedules

Schedule	How It Works	Practical Consideration
Daily	Available funds are paid on eligible business days.	Fast access; more bank deposits.
Weekly	Available funds accumulate for a weekly payout.	Fewer deposits to reconcile.
Monthly	Available funds accumulate for a monthly payout.	May fit monthly bookkeeping.
Manual	Funds remain until a payout is initiated.	Use only for a defined accounting reason.

NOTE

Available payout controls depend on AGAPAY's Stripe configuration. If the schedule control is not shown in Stripe Express, contact AGAPAY support.

Monthly Reconciliation Routine

- Export AGAPAY and Stripe transaction activity when available.
- Match each bank deposit to the related Stripe payout.
- Confirm gross gifts, total fees, refunds, disputes, and net deposits.
- Review restricted and designated gifts separately.
- Investigate unmatched deposits or missing transactions promptly.

PART 6

Donation Fees: What the Parish Receives

AGAPAY uses one combined transaction fee for standard online donations. The Stripe processing portion is included within the advertised total.

How the Total Fee Is Divided

Component	Standard Domestic Online Card Donation	Recipient
Stripe processing portion	Approximately 2.9% + \$0.30	Stripe
AGAPAY platform portion	Approximately 2.1%	AGAPAY
Total donation transaction fee	5% + \$0.30	Combined total
Net to parish	Donation minus 5% + \$0.30	Parish bank account

Correct Examples

	\$25 Gift	\$100 Gift	\$250 Gift
Donor gives	\$25.00	\$100.00	\$250.00
Total fee: 5% + \$0.30	-\$1.55	-\$5.30	-\$12.80
Approx. Stripe portion	-\$1.03	-\$3.20	-\$7.55
Approx. AGAPAY portion	-\$0.52	-\$2.10	-\$5.25
Net to parish	\$23.45	\$94.70	\$237.20

IMPORTANT

Do not subtract Stripe's 2.9% + \$0.30 and then subtract another 5% + \$0.30. The 5% + \$0.30 is the complete total donation fee.

PART 7

Parish+ Bookstore

Parish+ adds the AGAPAY Bookstore to the parish dashboard for in-person or online parish merchandise and book sales.

Parish+ Pricing & Fees

Item	Cost or Fee	What It Means
Parish+ subscription	\$39/month	Adds the Bookstore commerce tools to the parish account.
AGAPAY commerce transaction fee	\$0	AGAPAY takes no percentage or per-order fee on Bookstore sales.
Stripe processing	Applicable Stripe processing fees	Stripe may still charge its normal payment-processing costs.
Net commerce proceeds	Sale minus Stripe processing, refunds, and applicable adjustments	Deposited through the connected Stripe account.
KEY POINT	The donation fee and the Bookstore fee model are different. Donations use the combined 5% + \$0.30 fee. Bookstore commerce has no AGAPAY transaction fee.	

Bookstore Operations

- Add books or parish merchandise with names and prices.
- Review customer, item, quantity, sales amount, taxes collected, refunds, and net activity.
- Keep commerce income separate from charitable contributions in parish bookkeeping.
- Reconcile Bookstore orders against Stripe payment activity and bank payouts.
- Preserve receipts and order records for accounting and sales-tax purposes.

Weekly Treasurer Summary

When enabled in the live Parish+ implementation, the parish may receive a weekly Bookstore summary showing items sold, purchasers, item prices, total sales, taxes collected, and other useful reconciliation details. Confirm the current dashboard settings and recipient email before relying on the report.

PART 8

Records, Refunds, Disputes & Tax Notes

Refunds and Disputes

- Refunds reduce the available Stripe balance and may reduce a future payout.
- Disputes or chargebacks require prompt review and supporting records.
- Keep donor communications, receipts, order details, and fulfillment records.
- A negative Stripe balance may be offset against later incoming funds or payouts.

Charitable Gifts vs. Commerce

Activity	Bookkeeping Treatment
Donation	Record as a charitable contribution according to parish accounting policies and applicable law.
Bookstore sale	Record as commerce revenue, including sales price, applicable sales tax, refunds, and processing costs.
Mixed activity	Avoid treating a purchase as a charitable gift merely because it occurs through a parish platform.
TAX NOTE	Tax forms and reporting depend on the Stripe Connect configuration, transaction type, federal rules, and state requirements. A Form 1099-K reports gross processed payment activity; it does not determine whether the underlying funds are taxable. Consult the parish accountant or tax adviser.

Sales Tax

The parish is responsible for determining whether Bookstore products are taxable, registering when required, setting the correct tax treatment, filing returns, and remitting collected tax. AGAPAY is a software platform and does not replace parish-specific legal or tax advice.

TROUBLESHOOTING

Common Issues & Practical Responses

Stripe account is under review

- Open Stripe Express and read every alert.
- Check the representative email for document requests.
- Confirm the legal name and EIN match official records.
- Upload only clear, current documents.
- Contact AGAPAY when the request is unclear.

Payouts are not arriving

- Confirm funds are available rather than pending.
- Verify the payout bank account and account status.
- Review payout dates, banking holidays, and expected arrival.
- Check for negative balances, refunds, disputes, or verification restrictions.

Giving page is paused or hidden

- Confirm the Giving subscription is active.
- Confirm Stripe shows the account as able to accept payments and receive payouts.
- Set the Giving Page Status to Active.
- Test the public URL in a private browser window.

A dashboard or setup link does not work

- Return to the parish dashboard and request a fresh link when possible.
- Check spam and filtered email folders.
- Use the authorized parish email address when contacting support.
- Include the parish name, parish identifier, screenshot, and exact error message.

SECURITY

Never send full bank-account numbers, passwords, full Social Security numbers, or unredacted identity documents by ordinary email.

FINAL CHECKLIST

Before You Share the Giving Link or Open the Bookstore

- ☐ AGAPAY Giving subscription is active.
- ☐ Stripe account can accept payments and receive payouts.
- ☐ Parish bank account is verified.
- ☐ At least one designated fund is configured.
- ☐ Liturgical calendar and feast-aware settings are correct.
- ☐ Giving Page Status is Active.
- ☐ Dashboard password has been changed and securely stored.
- ☐ Giving link and QR code have been tested.
- ☐ A test donation appears correctly in AGAPAY and Stripe.
- ☐ Parish+ is active before Bookstore use.
- ☐ Bookstore products, prices, taxes, and receipt flow have been tested.
- ☐ Treasurer understands the different donation and commerce fee models.

Get Help

Email Support	Parish Dashboard	AGAPAY Website
support@agapay.app	agapay.app/parish/dashboard	agapay.app

God grant your parish many years of fruitful stewardship.

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